

# IELTS Academic Preparation

An 8-week, 16-class exam-preparation course for adults at B2 or above who need an IELTS Academic band score for university entry, professional registration, or a visa. Twice a week for 90 minutes, you learn how every section of the test works, practice each major question type, write and self-mark both Writing tasks, rehearse the Speaking interview, and take a diagnostic and two full practice tests. Between classes, the free online lessons (with audio) are your homework.

|                              |                         |                          |                           |
|------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------|
| LEVEL                        | DURATION                | EACH CLASS               | CONTENT                   |
| B2+ · target band<br>6.0–7.5 | 8 weeks · 16<br>classes | 90 minutes · 2 ×<br>week | 4 modules · 12<br>lessons |

## CLASS SCHEDULE

Two classes a week, 90 minutes each. Twelve classes each teach **one lesson** from the online course, and four are assessment classes: a **diagnostic** in Class 1, **Practice Test 1** (Listening and Reading) in Class 8, and **Practice Test 2** across Classes 15 and 16. Every lesson runs as an **exam-skills workshop**: strategy, guided practice, timed practice, self-marking against paraphrased band criteria, and targeted feedback. ✓ = the can-do goal for that class.

|                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| WEEK 1 Know the Test                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Module 1: orientation, a diagnostic, and a clear map of the test. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| C1                                                                | <div>DIAG</div> <b>Orientation + Diagnostic</b><br>course map · your target band and per-skill minimums · short Listening + Reading sections · a writing sample · a 3-minute speaking sample<br>✓ I know my starting point in each skill.                                              |
| C2                                                                | <div>1.1</div> <b>IELTS Overview — Format, Bands &amp; Strategy</b><br>Academic vs General Training · the four sections and their timing · the 9-band scale and overall rounding · never leave a blank · word limits<br>✓ I can explain how the test works and set a realistic target. |

**WEEK 2****Paraphrase & Grammar for a High Band**

**Module 1:** the language that underpins every section.

**C3****1.2****Academic Vocabulary & Paraphrasing**

synonyms · word class · structure · everyday vs academic register · the Academic Word List · topic vocabulary banks

✓ I can recognize paraphrase in questions and produce it in my own answers.

**C4****1.3****Grammar for a High Band**

subordination · relative, conditional, participle and noun clauses · tenses for trends and argument · articles, agreement, run-ons

✓ I can widen my grammatical range without losing accuracy.

**WEEK 3****Listening & Reading Strategies**

**Module 2:** the two receptive skills, one question type at a time.

**C5****2.1****Listening — Strategies & Question Types**

the four parts · predict, read ahead, follow signposts · distractors · form, map and diagram completion · spelling and word limits

✓ I can predict answers and avoid the penalties that turn right answers into zeros.

**C6****2.2****Reading — Skimming, Scanning & Question Types**

60 minutes, 3 passages, no transfer time · skim vs scan · keyword + paraphrase location · headings, completion, multiple choice

✓ I can manage the Reading clock and locate answers quickly.

**WEEK 4****The Tricky Types & Practice Test 1**

**Module 2:** True/False/Not Given, matching, and the first full timed test.

**C7****2.3****True/False/Not Given & Matching — The Tricky Types**

False (contradicted) vs Not Given (absent) · Yes/No/Not Given · matching headings · matching information and features

✓ I can justify True, False, or Not Given with evidence from the text.

**C8****TEST****Practice Test 1**

timed Listening (~30 min) + Reading (60 min) under real conditions · self-marked in Class 9

✓ I know my Listening and Reading bands and my top error types.

**WEEK 5****Academic Writing**

**Module 3:** both writing tasks, starting with data description.

C9

3.1

**Writing Task 1 — Describing Data**

opens with Practice Test 1 results · introduction → overview → body · select and group key features · trend, comparison and process language · 150 words in 20 minutes

✓ I can write a Task 1 report with a clear overview.

C10

3.2

**Writing Task 2 — Essay Structure & Argument**

question types · a 5-minute plan · thesis and topic sentences · reasons, consequences, examples · 250 words in 40 minutes

✓ I can plan and write a full Task 2 essay that answers the question.

**WEEK 6****The Writing Criteria & Speaking**

**Modules 3–4:** marking your own writing, then the Speaking interview.

C11

3.3

**Writing — Coherence, Cohesion & Band Descriptors**

the four Writing criteria · paragraphing and referencing · the over-linking trap · self-assessing against paraphrased band descriptors

✓ I can mark my own essay against the four criteria and set targets.

C12

4.1

**Speaking Parts 1–3 — Fluency & Strategy**

answer + why + example · the Part 2 cue card with one minute to prepare · Part 3 opinion, support and speculation

✓ I can extend my answers and speak for two minutes from a cue card.

**WEEK 7****Speaking Criteria & Test-Day Strategy**

**Module 4:** the Speaking criteria, then a plan for test day.

C13

4.2

**Speaking — Pronunciation, Lexical Range & Band Descriptors**

stress, intonation, chunking: clarity, not accent · collocation · paraphrasing when a word won't come · self-assessing a recording

✓ I can assess my own speaking and improve one criterion.

C14

4.3

**Full Practice & Test-Day Strategy**

the complete toolkit · a mini mock · the test-day checklist and nerves · a countdown study plan

✓ I can manage test day and plan my final weeks.

**WEEK 8****Practice Test 2 & the Finish Line**

**Module 4:** the second full practice test, a band debrief, and a celebration.

**C15****TEST****Practice Test 2, Part A**

timed Listening (~30 min) + Reading (60 min) under real conditions

✓ **I can take Listening and Reading under real test conditions.**

**C16****TEST****Practice Test 2, Part B + Celebration**

Writing Task 1 + Task 2 (60 min) · short individual speaking interviews · band debrief · celebration

✓ **I know my estimated band in every skill and my plan to test day.** 🎉

**EVERY CLASS, THE SAME SHAPE**

A steady routine helps learners stay calm under the clock. Timings flex from lesson to lesson; the Writing lessons give the timed task more time.

**0:00****Warmer & review of the last class**

A quick task that recycles last class's strategy, or returns test results

**0:10****Strategy input**

How the question type or task works, where the marks are, and a model answer

**0:25****Guided practice**

Workbook tasks in pairs · justify every answer with evidence

**0:45***Break (5 min)***0:50****Timed practice**

Under real test conditions: silence, no dictionaries, pencils down on time

**1:10****Self-marking & feedback**

Answer key or paraphrased band criteria · error tally on the band tracker · "I can..." checklist

**1:25****Homework set-up**

The online lesson with 🎧 audio + one workbook page

## COURSE DETAILS

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### ■ Prerequisites

- ◆ **CEFR B2 or above recommended.** You can follow fast natural speech on familiar topics, read longer articles, argue a point, and write a structured paragraph without much help.
- ◆ New to our program? Ask your teacher for the program's **placement test** first. Learners placing at B2, C1, or C2 are ready for this course.
- ◆ Placed at B1 or below, or at B2 with a large gap to your target band? Build your general English first with **Confident English (B2)** or **Advanced English (C1)**. Exam technique works best on a solid base.
- ◆ No computer needed in class. A phone or computer helps for homework and for recording speaking practice, but it isn't required.

### ■ What's Provided

- ◆ A **Student Workbook** for all 12 lessons, with original passages, charts, prompts, and cue cards (the learner keeps it)
- ◆ A **welcome handout** (timed-practice etiquette, test-anxiety tips, honest band expectations, QR codes to the online lessons) and a one-page **band tracker**
- ◆ For the teacher: a **Teacher's Guide** (a 90-minute plan for every class), slides, listening scripts, cue cards, games, the diagnostic, two practice tests, and answer keys
- ◆ Free access to the companion online course: **IELTS Academic Preparation**, with  audio
- ◆ A free **learning-tools** page that shows how to translate lessons into any language

## ■ Assessment

- ◆ **Every class:** timed practice, self-marking, and an “I can...” checklist, with no grades
- ◆ **Class 1 • Diagnostic:** short Listening and Reading sections, a writing sample, and a 3-minute speaking sample
- ◆ **Class 8 • Practice Test 1:** timed Listening and Reading, self-marked and converted to bands in Class 9
- ◆ **Classes 15–16 • Practice Test 2:** timed Listening and Reading, then Writing Task 1 + Task 2 (60 min) and a short individual speaking interview, followed by a band debrief
- ◆ Writing and Speaking are assessed against criteria **paraphrased from the public IELTS band descriptors**. All bands are **estimates** for planning, not official scores
- ◆ Scores are private. A gain of about half a band in eight weeks is common; bigger jumps are possible but not guaranteed

## ■ Homework & the Online Course

- ◆ After each class, do the matching **online lesson** at home: about **45–60 minutes**, with  Listen buttons for model sentences
- ◆ Plus one **workbook page**, 15 minutes of English every day, and one timed task each week from your band tracker plan
- ◆ Missed a class? The online lesson covers the same strategies, so you can catch up. Missed a practice test? Ask your teacher how to take it at home, timed
- ◆ The online lessons and the classroom materials both use American English. IELTS accepts American or British spelling, as long as you use one consistently

## What You'll Be Able to Do

By the end of the course, learners know the IELTS Academic test inside out and can perform closer to their true level under exam conditions:

- ✓ Explain the format, timing, and scoring, and set a realistic target with per-skill minimums
- ✓ Use a range of complex structures while keeping errors under control
- ✓ Skim, scan, and manage 60 minutes across three Reading passages
- ✓ Write a Task 1 report with a clear overview in about 20 minutes
- ✓ Extend Speaking answers and deliver a two-minute Part 2 long turn
- ✓ Recognize paraphrase in questions and use it to raise Lexical Resource
- ✓ Predict Listening answers, avoid distractors, and meet spelling and word-limit rules
- ✓ Tell False from Not Given and match headings with a repeatable method
- ✓ Plan and write a Task 2 essay that fully answers the question in about 40 minutes
- ✓ Self-assess Writing and Speaking against the criteria, manage nerves, and plan the final weeks to test day

Companion course, free online: [rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts](https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts) · Free translation & learning tools: [rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum/learning-tools.html](https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum/learning-tools.html) · More general English first: B2 · C1

This course is independent. It is not affiliated with or endorsed by the IELTS partners, and it does not use official test material.

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**Ray de la Paz**

v1.0 · 8 weeks · 16 classes · 24 instructional hours

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